Ibrahim & Junaid

THE ICE HOCKEY GAME

BOOK 1



ABRAR INSTITUTE

A Notice on the Board

Thursday morning. One notice is about to turn an ordinary school week upside down.



Ibrahim: Saturday! Look, Junaid! A proper game. With a referee, a scoreboard... everything!

Junaid: Does everything include a way of stopping without sitting down?

Ibrahim: That's called practice.



Junaid: I get plenty of practice on my bike. It has brakes. Very useful invention, brakes.

Ibrahim: Skates have brakes too. You just have to learn the turn.

Junaid: Mine haven't read the instructions.



Ibrahim: Imagine scoring the winning goal! There might even be talent scouts.

Junaid: One thing at a time, superstar. First, let's persuade my feet to travel in the same direction.

A New Teammate

In class, the boys discover that they are not the only ones thinking about hockey.

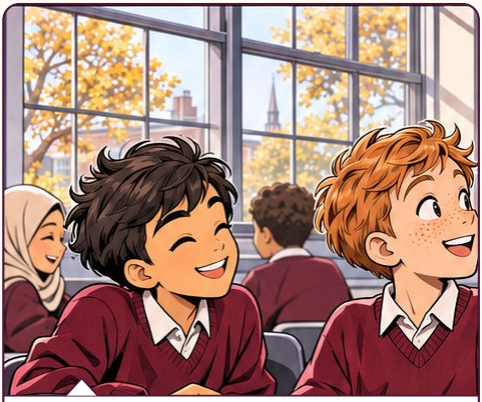


Junaid: Is that a hockey rink in your notebook?

Sam: Yes. The little dot lying down is me.

Ibrahim: You're playing on Saturday too?

Sam: If my skates agree to it.



Sam: I've only just started. Sometimes I turn left and they carry straight on.

Junaid: Excellent. We can start a club.

Ibrahim: A hockey club?

Junaid: A club for people whose feet won't listen.



Ibrahim: Come to practice with us today. We can help.

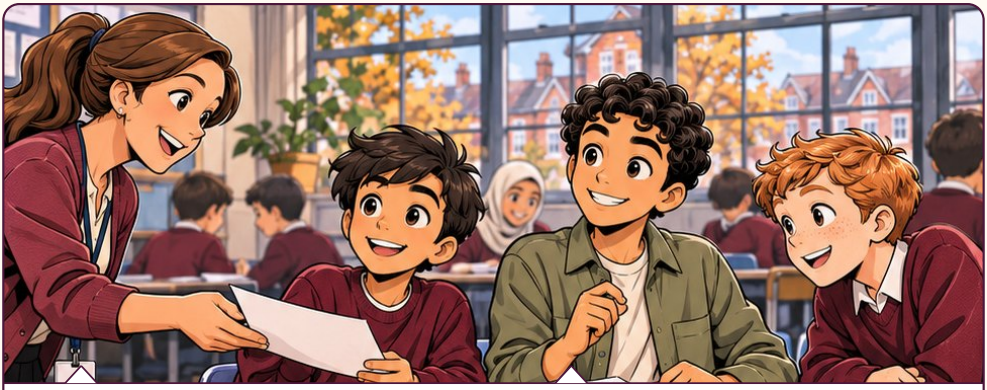
Sam: Even if I'm the slowest?

Junaid: Especially then. Nobody should have to argue with two skates on their own.

Sam: All right. I'm in!

The Big Plan

Ms Reed has a challenge of her own: build a bridge from paper and tape.



Ms Reed: Your bridge must hold a rubber. Everyone gets the same supplies, so you'll need to work together.

Sam: I've built something that looks like a sandwich.

Junaid: A promising start. I'm hungry.



Junaid: Ibrahim? We need another pair of hands.

Ibrahim: Just a second. I'm planning our attack.

Junaid: Why is your name beside every arrow?

Ibrahim: Because I know exactly where I'll be.



Sam: Our bridge is going down!

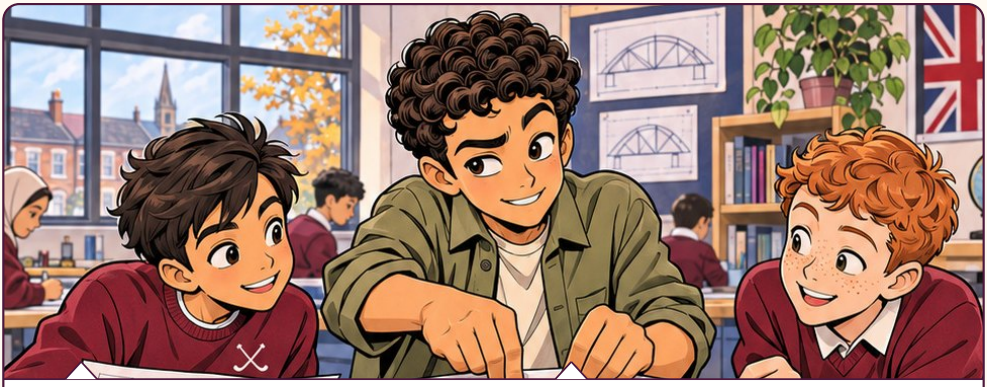
Junaid: Quick, hold that end!

Ibrahim: Oh! I thought you had it.

Sam: We did. What we needed was a third builder. Preferably one who's actually here.

Nobody Builds Alone

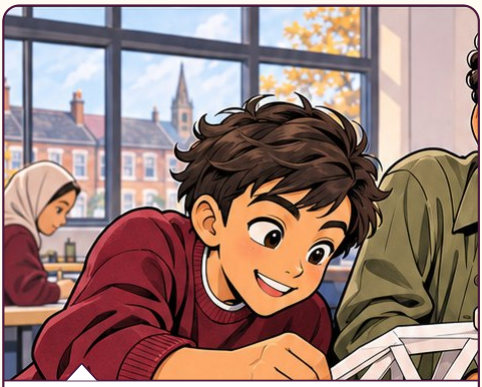
This time, all three boys put their hands—and their ideas—to work.



Junaid: I'll fold the supports. Sam, can you hold the middle?

Sam: Steadier than I am on ice, I promise.

Junaid: Ibrahim, tear some tape. Your brilliant plan needs you right here.



Ibrahim: What if we fold the edges up? That might make the bridge stronger.

Sam: Yes! And another support underneath.

Junaid: There. Three ideas are doing better than one.

Ibrahim: Mine was a good idea, though.



Sam: It holds! Put the rubber on!

Ibrahim: My rubber! I've been looking everywhere for that.

Junaid: Our first team success.

Sam: The bridge or finding his rubber?

Junaid: Both. Both took considerable teamwork.

Off to the Rink

After school, Grandad meets them outside with room in the car for three very large sports bags.

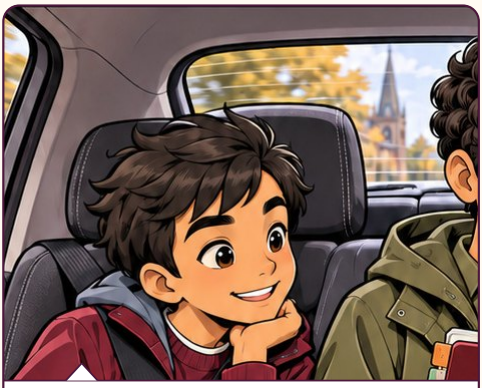


Grandad: Goodness! Are you taking equipment or moving house?

Ibrahim: Just the essentials.

Sam: I've brought two spare pairs of socks.

Junaid: I've brought hope. It was lighter than another bag.



Ibrahim: Today I'm practising my winning shot.

Sam: I'm practising not falling over.

Junaid: I've already mastered sitting on a bicycle. Surely that's useful experience.

Grandad: It depends how much sitting the game allows.



Junaid: Grandad, we're still going to the mosque afterwards, aren't we?

Grandad: Yes. Your clean clothes are packed, and we've left enough time.

Ibrahim: Time for a few extra shots?

Grandad: And time to pack your own bag afterwards.

Equipment First

At the rink, Coach Harris starts with the most important job of all.



Coach: Helmets secure? Face guards fitted? Gloves and pads? We check everything before anyone goes on the ice.

Ibrahim: Ready, Coach!

Junaid: Nearly. My glove appears to have eaten my thumb.



Coach: Try the other hand, Junaid.

Junaid: Ah. That would explain it.

Sam: Hang on. You've both given me a left glove.

Ibrahim: Two left gloves?

Sam: Are you making a prediction about my skating?



Ibrahim: Only about our ability to hand out gloves.

Coach: Good. Then we know what the first team lesson is.

Junaid: Know your left from your right?

Coach: Help each other. Knowing left from right would also be useful.

The Invisible Hole

For the first few minutes, the ice seems determined to win every argument.



Sam: Whoa—whoa—there was a hole!

Ibrahim: Are you all right?

Sam: Yes. I found the ice. With the wrong part of me.

Junaid: That hole must be very well hidden.



Sam: It was right here. A completely invisible hole.

Junaid: Extraordinary. My bike never has those.

Ibrahim: Your bike once stopped in a hedge.

Junaid: That was an extremely visible hedge. Entirely different problem.



Coach: Take your time, Sam. We'll practise getting up, then stopping. No rush.

Sam: Even if everyone has to wait?

Coach: That's what practice is for.

Junaid: And nobody's becoming an expert before tea. Probably.

Pass or Shoot?

Then Coach sets a passing drill. Ibrahim sees something more exciting: an open goal.



Junaid: Over here, Ibrahim! I'm free!

Ibrahim: I can see the goal!

Junaid: Yes. I was rather hoping you could see your teammate too.

Ibrahim: One quick shot. Watch this!



Ibrahim thinks: *The angle is small. But if I hit it hard enough...*

CLACK!

Sam: Well, the boards certainly noticed.

Junaid: So did everyone in the next rink.

Ibrahim: That wasn't quite what I meant.



Coach: Before you decide, look around. Who could help you?

Ibrahim: I thought I could do it.

Coach: Trying a shot isn't the problem. Forgetting your teammates is.

Junaid: I was still here, in case you wondered.

Left Out

In the next drill, Sam calls for the puck. Ibrahim hears him—and keeps going.



Sam: I'm free! Ibrahim!

Ibrahim thinks: *If Sam loses it, our attack is over. I'll take it myself.*

Junaid: Sam's waiting!

Ibrahim: Just give me a second!

Sam: I've been giving you several.



Junaid: You didn't even look at him.

Ibrahim: He might lose the puck.

Junaid: So might you.

Ibrahim: That's different.

Junaid: Only because you're the one holding the stick.

Ibrahim: I just want us to win.



Junaid: So do I. But if Sam never gets a pass, how can he improve?

Ibrahim: We haven't got forever.

Junaid: Then let's use practice to practise being a team. Not just watching you play.

Words That Hurt

A small disagreement turns into something much harder to put right.



Ibrahim: You could try wanting to win for once!

Junaid: What? Of course I want to win.

Ibrahim: Then stop worrying about every little mistake!

Junaid: I wasn't worrying about mistakes. I was thinking about Sam.



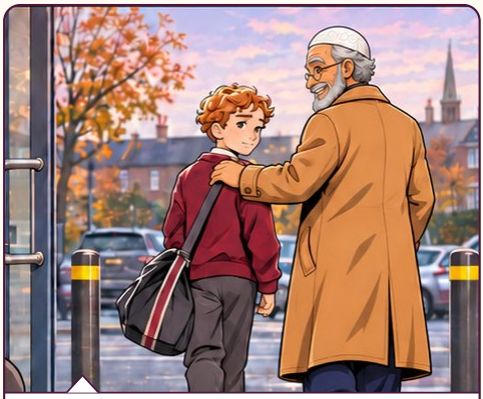
Sam: I heard you. I know I'm not the best player.

Ibrahim: Sam, I didn't—

Sam: My family are here. See you tomorrow.

Junaid: Sam...

Sam: It's all right. I've got my bag.



Ibrahim: Why did I say that?

Junaid: I don't know. But it hurt.

Ibrahim: I was cross.

Junaid: You can be cross without being cruel.

Ibrahim thinks: *I wish putting words back was as easy as picking up a puck.*

A Quiet Car Ride

After seeing Sam off with his family, Grandad drives the boys to the mosque. The car is unusually quiet.



Grandad: Was practice difficult?

Ibrahim: A bit.

Junaid: More than a bit.

Grandad: I see. Is it a problem with the skates, or something that won't fit in a sports bag?

Ibrahim: The second one.

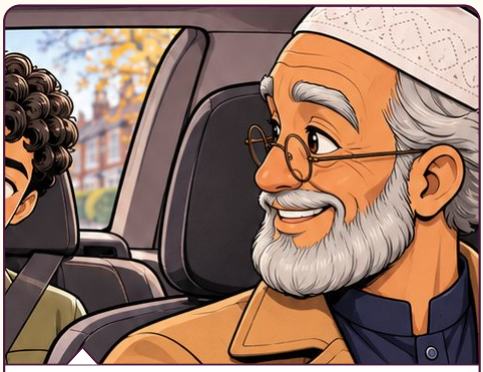


Ibrahim: Grandad, have you ever said something you wanted to take back?

Grandad: More than once.

Junaid: What did you do?

Grandad: First, I stopped pretending that the other person hadn't been hurt.



Grandad: If you'd like to talk, I'm listening. We don't have to solve everything in the car.

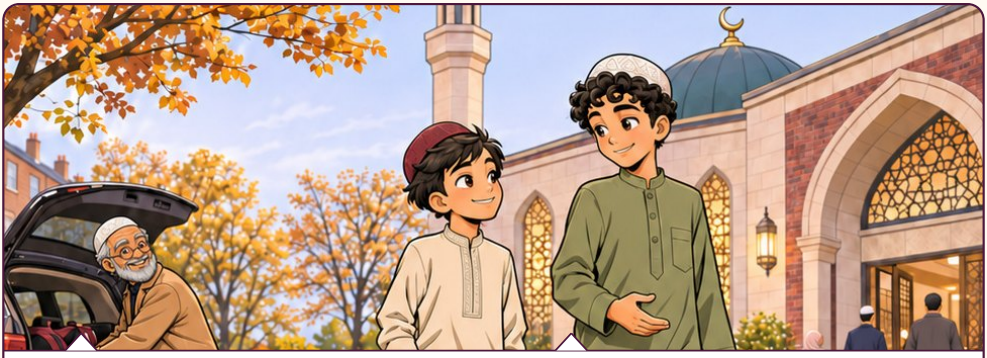
Ibrahim: Good. I don't know where to start.

Grandad: Sometimes an honest first sentence is enough.

Junaid: We can help you find it.

A Familiar Place

Sam has gone home with his family. Ibrahim and Junaid go to the mosque with Grandad.



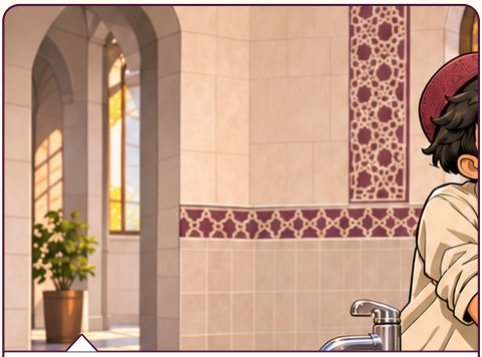
Junaid: We're in time for the prayer.

Ibrahim: Good. I don't want to rush.

Grandad: I'll put the bags away. You two get ready.

Ibrahim: I've remembered my clean clothes.

Junaid: A small but important victory.



Junaid: Your sleeve is in the water.

Ibrahim: Again? My sleeve has worked harder here than it did at practice.

Junaid: You can roll it a little higher.

Ibrahim: Thanks. I can manage a hockey stick. Apparently sleeves are more complicated.



Ibrahim: Junaid... I am sorry about what I said.

Junaid: I know. Let's talk properly afterwards.

Grandad: Ready, boys?

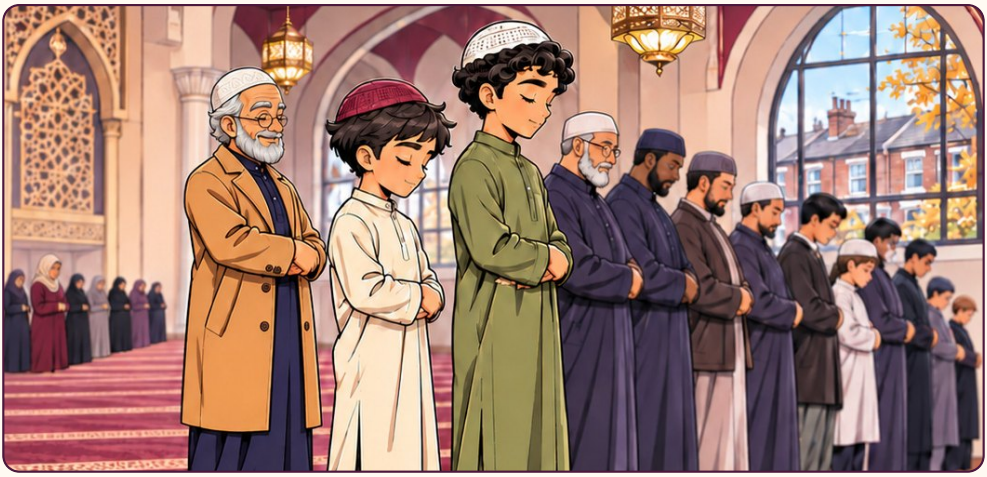
Ibrahim: Nearly.

Junaid: Yes. And the sleeve has finally finished washing.

Ibrahim: Very funny. Come on, then.

A Moment of Peace

A quiet moment for prayer. Afterwards, Grandad listens to what happened at the rink.





Ibrahim: I was unkind to Sam. He made a mistake, and I made him feel as if he didn't belong.

Grandad: Thank you for telling me honestly.

Ibrahim: I wish I'd been more patient.



Grandad: Anas served the Prophet for ten years. He described how the Prophet never even spoke an impatient 'uff' to him.

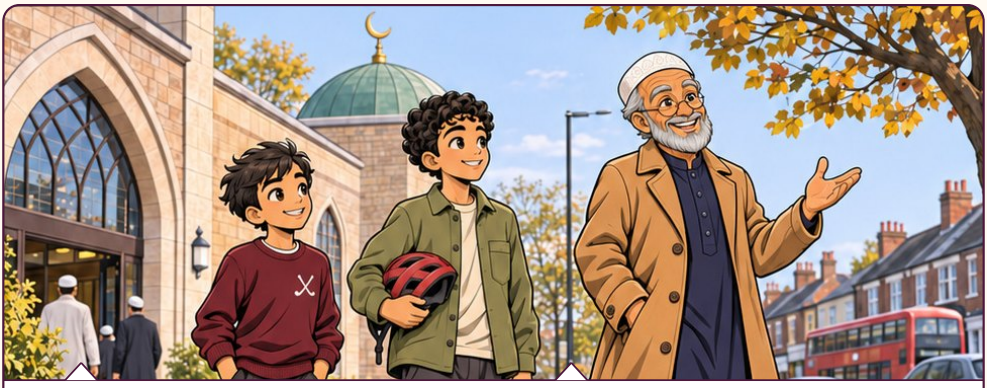
Junaid: Ten years is a lot of chances to get annoyed.

Ibrahim: And I lost my temper over one pass.

Retold from: al-Bukhari 6038

More Than a Magic Shot

Outside, Ibrahim finds that saying what frightened him is harder than admitting he was angry.



Ibrahim: I was worried I'd play badly. I wanted everyone to think I was good.

Junaid: And I thought you didn't want to play with us.

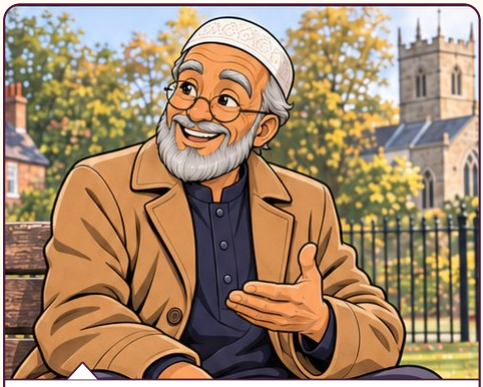
Ibrahim: That isn't true. I do. Really.



Grandad: The Prophet also taught that real strength means controlling yourself when you're angry.

Ibrahim: So being strong isn't just hitting the puck harder.

Grandad: You can feel angry and still choose what you do next.



Junaid: When we cycle, I don't leave you behind just because I can go faster.

Ibrahim: I know. And I shouldn't leave Sam out.

Grandad: What could you do tomorrow?

Ibrahim: Apologise. Then show him I mean it.

Retold from: Muslim 2609a

The Apology

On Friday morning, Ibrahim catches Sam before the first lesson.



Ibrahim: Sam? Yesterday I wouldn't pass to you. Then I said something unkind. I'm sorry.

Sam: You made it sound as if I was ruining the team.

Ibrahim: I know. That was wrong.



Sam: I'm still learning. I can't promise never to lose the puck.

Ibrahim: Neither can I. I was expecting you to do something I can't do myself.

Sam: So what happens if I miss again?

Ibrahim: We try again.



Junaid: Shall we start with a team snack break? I've brought enough for three.

Sam: Now there's a team activity I understand.

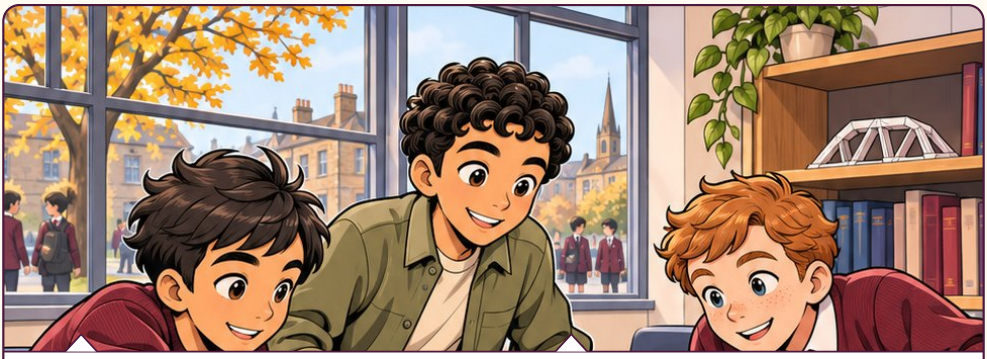
Ibrahim: Can I have the biggest sandwich?

Junaid: And there's our next teamwork lesson.

Sam: I'll help teach it.

Practice Without Ice

At break, the team finds an ice rink that doesn't require helmets—or ice.



Ibrahim: Paper puck ready? Look first. Then pass.

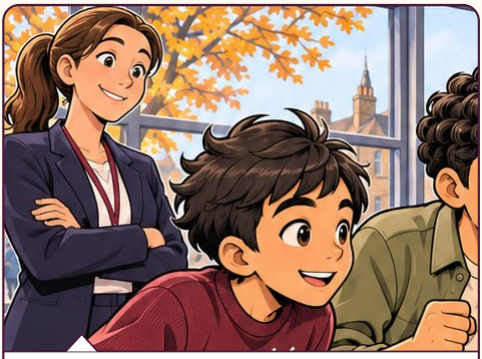
Sam: This ice is surprisingly warm.

Junaid: Very easy to stand on, though.

Ibrahim: Sam, you're free. Here!

Sam: And the crowd goes wild!

Junaid: That's the lunch queue.



Sam: Look! I stopped it properly.

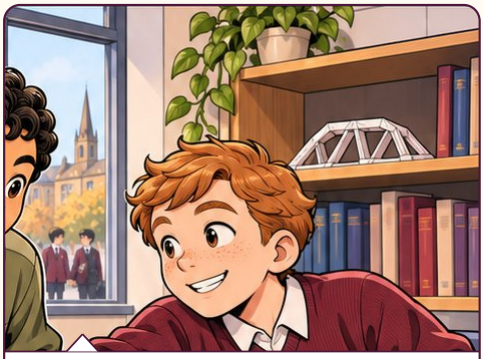
Ibrahim: Now find someone to pass to.

Sam: You or Junaid?

Junaid: A difficult choice. I'm taller, but he shouts more.

Ibrahim: I do not!

Sam: Excellent demonstration. Thank you.



Ms Reed: Another building project?

Junaid: A team, this time.

Ms Reed: Any useful discoveries?

Sam: It works better when everyone gets a turn.

Ibrahim: And when someone remembers to bring sandwiches.

Junaid: A very important structural support.

A Promise

Saturday arrives much sooner than Junaid's feet would have preferred.



Coach: Look out for each other. Every one of you belongs here.

Sam: Even the player who fell into the invisible hole?

Coach: Especially him. You got up and tried again.

Junaid: That hole has a promising sporting career.



Ibrahim: Sam, if you're free, call for me. I promise I'll look.

Sam: Loudly or very loudly?

Junaid: For him? Very loudly.

Ibrahim: I heard that.

Junaid: Good. Your listening practice is already working.



Coach: Hands in. Whatever happens, we play together.

Ibrahim: Together.

Sam: Even if I miss?

Junaid: Even then.

Sam: All right. Let's give my skates something useful to do.

Ibrahim: Now you're talking!

Coach: Onto the ice, team.

Game On!

The referee calls the players into position. Suddenly, the rink seems twice as big.



Sam: There are a lot of people watching.

Junaid: Don't count them. It makes it worse.

Ibrahim: Watch the puck instead.

Junaid: And your teammates.

Ibrahim: Yes. Them too.

PEEP!



Ibrahim thinks: *Here we go. A proper game. Don't rush. Find Junaid.*

Junaid: Ibrahim! Over here!

Ibrahim: I've seen you!

Sam: Now that's an improvement.

Junaid: Save the review until the puck gets here!



Junaid: Back to you!

Ibrahim: Got it! Sam, keep moving!

Sam: I am moving. I'm trying to stop moving quite so much.

Coach: Good start! Keep your heads up!

Ibrahim thinks: *We can do this. All of us.*

A Goal for the Other Team

Then a pass is intercepted, and the other team races towards goal.



Junaid: They're through!

Ibrahim: Get back!

Sam: I'm coming!

CLACK!

Ibrahim thinks: *Too late.*

Junaid: One-nil. There's still time.

Ibrahim: There was hardly a gap!

Sam: They found it, though.



Ibrahim thinks: *I can't make another mistake. Everyone will remember if I do.*

Sam: Ibrahim?

Ibrahim: What?

Sam: You're gripping your stick as if it owes you money.

Junaid: It probably owes him a winning goal.



Sam: We're still in the game.

Junaid: One goal doesn't finish it.

Ibrahim: I know. I just hate being behind.

Sam: Then let's go forward. Preferably together.

Ibrahim: Right. Next chance, we make it count.

An Old Habit

A gap opens. Ibrahim sees the goal—and feels the old urge to do everything himself.



Ibrahim thinks: *I could squeeze through. One quick shot. If it goes in, I can fix everything.*

Junaid: Ibrahim, look up!

Sam: I'm free!

Ibrahim thinks: *But what if he loses it again?*



Ibrahim thinks: *Grandad said I can choose what I do next. Sam needs a chance, not another lecture.*

Sam: Over here!

Junaid: He's in space!

Ibrahim thinks: *Trust him. That's what I promised.*



Ibrahim: Sam!

Sam: To me?

Ibrahim: Yes, to you! Stick down!

Sam: Right! I've got it!

Junaid: Go on, Sam!

Ibrahim thinks: *There. I've passed. The world hasn't ended. Now run—no, skate! Help him!*

The First Try

Sam reaches for the puck. For a moment, it looks perfect. Then it slides away.



Sam: Oh no—

Ibrahim: Sam!

Sam: I had it. I really did!

Other player: Our puck!

Junaid: Back, everyone!

Ibrahim thinks: *We worked so hard for that chance. And now it's gone.*



Sam: I'm sorry! I didn't mean to—

Ibrahim thinks: *I could shout. I want to. But look at his face.*

Ibrahim: It's all right. Next time! Come on!

Sam: You're not angry?

Ibrahim: I'm defending. Help me!



Junaid: Well said.

Ibrahim: Tell me later! They're coming!

Sam: I'm here!

Coach: Keep working together!

Ibrahim thinks: *Being kind didn't stop me wanting to win. It just stopped me hurting my friend.*

Junaid: We've still got a chance!

The Equaliser

Junaid wins the puck back. This time, the whole team is looking for one another.



Junaid: Ibrahim!

Ibrahim: Here!

Sam: I'm moving into space!

Ibrahim: I can see you!

Junaid: Then use him!

Ibrahim thinks: *Not because I have to. Because he's my teammate. And he's ready.*



Ibrahim: Sam! Your pass!

Sam: Stop it. Look up. Don't panic...

Junaid: Across to me!

Sam: I see you!

Ibrahim: You've got time!

Sam: Funny. My feet haven't noticed.

Junaid: Your hands have. Pass!



Sam: Junaid!

CLACK!

Junaid: YES!

Ibrahim: It's in! One-all!

Sam: That was my pass!

Junaid: It was!

Ibrahim: And mine before yours!

Sam: Are we listing everyone? We'll need a much bigger scoreboard!

A Different Kind of Celebration

For the first time all day, the best part isn't who scored.



Junaid: Your pass was perfect!

Sam: You mean my second one?

Ibrahim: And you didn't give up after the first.

Sam: Neither did you. On me, I mean.

Ibrahim: I said I'd try again. So did you.



Junaid: For the record, I did actually score.

Sam: We noticed. The jumping about was a clue.

Ibrahim: Careful. Your talent scouts might think you're a cyclist in disguise.

Junaid: I am a cyclist in disguise. These are terrible wheels.



Coach: Great teamwork! Now back to your positions.

Sam: We can't celebrate for five more minutes?

Coach: Not unless you'd like the other team to join in. With another goal.

Ibrahim: Positions! Quickly!

Junaid: There he is. Captain Loud again.

A Helping Hand

Near the boards, an opponent slips. The whistle stops play.



PEEP!

Sam: He's down!

Junaid: Give him room.

Ibrahim: Are you all right?

Other player: I think so. My feet went one way and I went the other.

Ibrahim: We've had some experience of that.



Other player: I'm fine. Only my pride is hurt.

Ibrahim: Ours has taken a few tumbles too.

Sam: Mine lives on the ice now.

Coach: Take a moment. Can you stand comfortably?

Other player: Yes. Thanks.



Other player: You could have just skated away.

Ibrahim: The whistle had gone. Besides, you're still a person when you wear the other shirt.

Junaid: A remarkably sensible observation.

Sam: Don't distract him. He might make another.

Ibrahim: Very funny. Come on.

The Final Attack

Nine seconds remain. One-all. One last chance.



Junaid: Ibrahim! On your right!

Ibrahim: I'm going!

Sam: I'll keep this side open!

Ibrahim thinks: *One good pass. One good shot. Come on...*

Junaid: NOW!

Coach: Keep going!

Ibrahim: Got it!



Ibrahim thinks: *There's the gap!*

THWACK!

Sam: Go on!

Junaid: Oh!

Ibrahim: The keeper saved it!

Sam: One more try?

Ibrahim thinks: *The clock! There's no—*

PEEP!

Junaid: That's it. Full time.



Ibrahim: So close.

Junaid: Good effort.

Sam: One-all. We didn't lose.

Ibrahim: We didn't win either.

Junaid: No. But would you have trusted that pass on Thursday?

Ibrahim: Probably not.

Sam: Then something important has changed.

Ibrahim: Yes. It has.

No Trophy. Still a Good Day.

There is no trophy to lift. There are still hands to shake.



Other player: Good shot at the end.

Ibrahim: Your keeper was annoyingly good.

Other player: I'll tell him. He enjoys being annoying.

Junaid: Good game.

Sam: Can you tell me how you stop that quickly?

Other player: Practice. Lots of it.



Sam: I set up a goal.

Junaid: You did.

Sam: In an actual game. With a referee.

Ibrahim: We were there, Sam.

Sam: Just checking. It sounded rather unlikely when I said it out loud.

Junaid: Say it again. You earned it.



Ibrahim: I'm glad you played.

Sam: Even after that first missed pass?

Ibrahim: Especially after you kept trying.

Junaid: And we weren't playing against one another.

Ibrahim: I'm getting used to that.

Sam: Good. I was hoping we could do it again.

The Team Photo

Afterwards, Grandad wants to hear everything. Unfortunately, everyone starts at once.



Grandad: How did the game go?

Ibrahim: One-all!

Sam: I only fell over once!

Junaid: I scored!

Grandad: An excellent collection of headlines. Now, one at a time.

Ibrahim: Can I start?

Junaid: That depends. Will you pass the story on afterwards?



Grandad: And how did you get on as a team?

Ibrahim: Better. I nearly shouted once. But I didn't.

Grandad: What did you do instead?

Ibrahim: Helped Sam try again.

Sam: That made it much easier.

Junaid: For all of us.



A little earlier, when it was time for the team photo...

Ibrahim: Hang on! We're missing our passing expert!

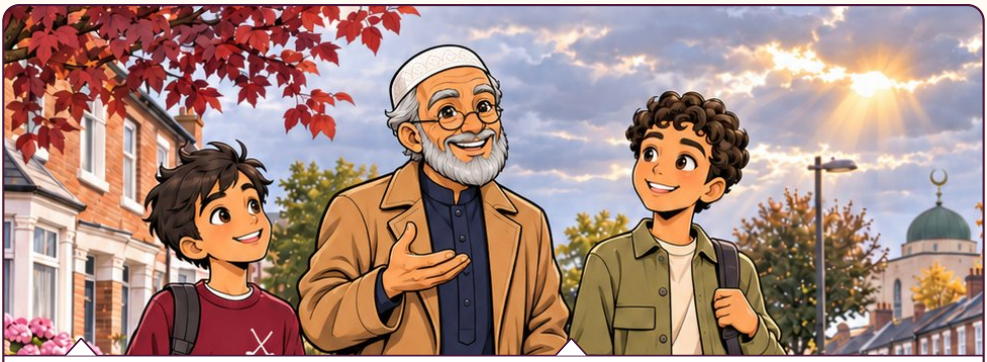
Sam: I was trying not to be in the way.

Junaid: You're in the team. Get in the picture!

Sam: All right. Nobody say 'fall over'!

A Plan for Monday

On the way home, the conversation finally returns to something other than hockey. Almost.



Junaid: On Monday, let's show Sam the school library.

Ibrahim: And I'll lend him my rubber.

Junaid: If you can find it.

Grandad: Perhaps the bridge can lend it back.

Ibrahim: That bridge is getting far too much credit.



Junaid: Next weekend, I'll show you my cycling route.

Ibrahim: Deal. Then you're the coach.

Grandad: Will you remember to wait for each other?

Junaid: Of course.

Ibrahim: And can the bike have instructions? Apparently some equipment doesn't listen.



Later, Ibrahim gives his old plan a few important improvements.

Junaid: You've crossed out most of your own names.

Ibrahim: I'm putting everyone else in.

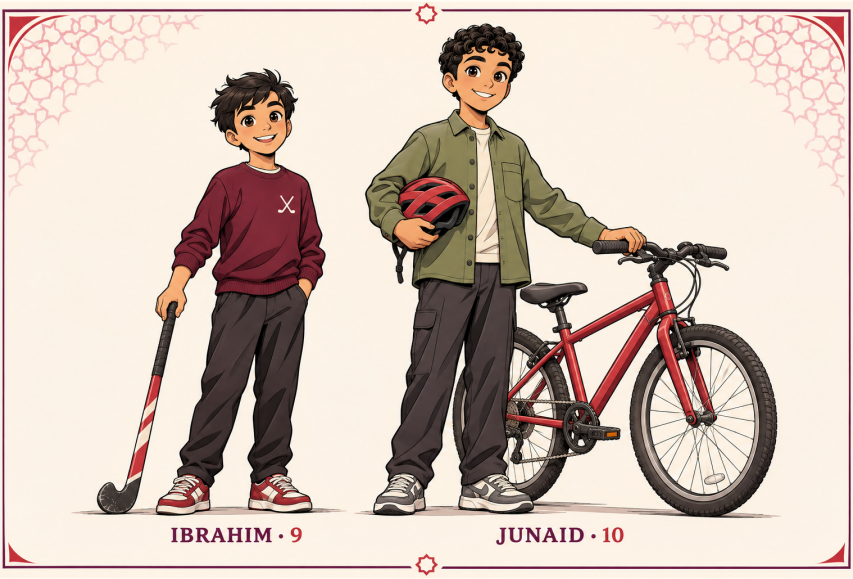
Junaid: Any brilliant new strategy?

Ibrahim: Yes. Now it looks like a team.

Junaid: That might just work.

The End

Better Together



Ibrahim loves ice hockey. His taller friend Junaid feels much more at home on a bike. As their first game draws closer, Ibrahim becomes determined to win. But a hurtful remark puts their friendship to the test.

Can he control his temper and trust his teammates when it matters most?

Learning from the Prophet Muhammad
Anas described his patient kindness in Sahih al-Bukhari 6038. The teaching about controlling anger is in Sahih Muslim 2609a. Both teachings are retold in child-friendly language. The modern adventure is fictional.

Sources: sunnah.com/bukhari:6038 · sunnah.com/muslim:2609a